## About the Author



**Mary Botham Howitt** (1799-1888) was an English poet. She was born at Coleford, in Gloucestershire. She was educated at home and read widely. She commenced writing verses at a very early age. Together with her husband William Howitt, she wrote over 180 books.

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## Glossary

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| **parlour** (n) | - | a tidy room in a house used for entertaining guests |
| **winding** (v) | - | a twisting movement or course |
| **weary** (v) | - | very tired, especially from hard work |
| **pantry** (n) | - | a room where beverages, food, dishes are stored |
| **subtle** (adj.) | - | delicate or faint and mysterious |
| **flattering** (v) | - | to praise or compliment insincerely |
| **counsellor** (n) | - | a person who advises |

## A. Read the following lines from the poem and answer the questions in a sentence or two.

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1. "*The way into my parlour is up a winding stair,*
*And I've many curious things to show when you are there*"

   a) How can the fly reach the spider's parlour?

   b) What will the fly get to see in the parlour?

2. "*Oh no, no," said the little Fly, "kind Sir, that cannot be,*
*I've heard what's in your pantry, and I do not wish to see!*"

   a) Is the fly willing to enter the spider's pantry?

   b) Can you guess what was in the pantry?

3. "*Sweet creature!" said the Spider, "You're witty and you're wise,*
*How handsome are your gauzy wings, how brilliant are your eyes!*"

   a) List the words used by the spider to describe the fly.

   b) Why does the spider say that the fly is witty?



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